

Application: Google

Steps:

Go to takeout.google.com

Sign in

Select which services (or “Select all”)

Click Next Step

Choose file type, frequency & destination

Choose delivery method (email link)

Frequency: Export once

Choose file type (.zip usually)

Choose File Size (I chose the default 2GB)

Click Create Export

Wait (can take hours to days)

Go to YOUR EXPORTS

Download the file

“Your total request size is 9.24 GB (9.24e+9 bytes). This request has been divided into 8 files.

Avoid downloading your data backup onto public computers or saving them where others can see them.

Part 1

2 GB (2e+9 bytes)

Download started February 27, 2026 at 3:33 PM

Part 2

2 GB (2e+9 bytes)

Part 3

2 GB (2e+9 bytes)

Part 4

1.27 GB (1.27e+9 bytes)

Part 5

551.2 MB (5.51e+8 bytes)

Part 6

5 MB (5e+6 bytes)

Part 7

1.24 GB (1.24e+9 bytes)

Part 8

194.8 MB (1.948e+8 bytes) ”

The eight parts are split up into categories in key areas,

Gmail & Correspondence: All emails, including spam and trash, and attachments.

Google Photos & Videos: Uploaded photos and videos, albums, and metadata.

Google Drive Files: Created or uploaded documents, spreadsheets, presentations, and other files.

Search & Browser History: Google search history, browsing history, bookmarks, and saved passwords if Chrome is used.

Location History: Logs of physical location, often recorded from an Android device or Google Maps.

YouTube Activity: Search history, watch history, liked videos, subscriptions, and comments.

Account & Activity Data: Information on account use, including Google Assistant recordings, Gemini chats, and Android device configurations.

Personal Information & Payments: Contacts, Calendar events, and purchase/transaction history from Google Pay.

b.) Google stores data in its massive global network of data centers, possibly including Canada (Montreal, Toronto), several states in the United States, and international centers in Europe and Asia.

How I concluded this:

I checked Google’s official Data Center Locations listing, which shows cities and regions worldwide where data centers exist.

I confirmed that Google also has cloud regions in Canada (Montreal and Toronto), meaning Canadian data may be stored locally, though replicated globally as needed.

Additional tech sources list specific continents and cities where Google data centers serve user data.

Cites:

Locations of Google Data Centers. (2019). Google Data Centers.

<https://datacenters.google/locations/>

Matteo Duò. (2021). Kinsta®. <https://kinsta.com/changelog/google-cloud-toronto-data-center/>

<https://blogv.it.com/global-data-storage/where-does-google-store-data/> (Can't cite this due to a captcha.)

Application: Instagram

Steps:

Log in to Instagram

Go to Settings

Click Settings

Go to See more in Accounts Center

Click Your information and permissions

Click Export your information

Click Create Export

Export to device

Select date range + format (HTML recommended)

Click Start export

Wait for the notification

Go to Current activity

Click Download

File Size: 138MB (1.38e+8 bytes)

Instagram doesn't publicly list exact server addresses or a single location where individual data is stored; instead, it's distributed and replicated across multiple Meta data centers in multiple countries, especially the U.S. (e.g., Iowa, Ohio, Virginia), Europe (e.g., Ireland, Sweden, Denmark), and Singapore (Asia).

How I arrived at this conclusion:

I checked the Instagram Help/Data Notice, which explains where Instagram may store your information.

I used infrastructure information from a Meta data center list to find specific regions/cities where Meta runs large server facilities likely used for Instagram.

Many tech research sites confirm Instagram is part of Meta's global infrastructure (shared servers), so the same data centers likely host Instagram data.

Cites:

Information for people who don't use Meta Products | Instagram Help Center. (2016).

Facebook.com. <https://www.facebook.com/help/instagram/261704639352628>

Zhang, M. (2024, June 21). *Meta's Data Center Locations for Facebook and Instagram.*

Dgtl Infra. <https://dgtlinfra.com/meta-data-center-locations-facebook/>